

DARPAVERSE Questions and Answers

Q1: Will submissions to the DARPAVERSE special topic be assessed in monthly collection periods like the main ERIS announcement or only at the end of the 12/31/25 closing date?

A1: DARPAVERSE submissions will be assessed on a monthly collection schedule as stated in the main ERIS announcement.

Q2: The DARPAVERSE announcement does not specify a target TRL for submissions, is it open to the full range of TRL similar to the main announcement (i.e., innovative research idea thru established prototype solution)?

A2: DARPAVERSE is open to all TRL submissions that demonstrate a path to solving the challenges outlined in the special notice.

Q3: There is no mention of recommended, expected, or planned cost for submissions to DARPAVERSE, which may result in a large range of complexity and scope in the submission offerings. In addition, under the main ERIS announcement, cost is not an evaluation factor. We understand that there is a planned program negotiation event that will include presentation of pricing information, but guidance will have direct impact on the project scope and complexity during the initial stage. Can any guidance on anticipated or recommended cost be provided to aid in scoping the submissions?

A3: The DARPAVERSE program for performers has an 8-month Period of Performance (PoP) and is meant to validate the feasibility of initial approaches. Performers should propose costs based on their technical approach, ensuring competitive pricing.

Q4: What is the anticipated period of performance duration?

A4: The period of performance is 8 months.

Q5: What is the anticipated size of effort (e.g. people, organizations or dollars)?

A5: See answer A3.

Q6: Is the government open to commercial organizations participating that assert rights on existing baseline software and provide government rights on newly developed software?

A6: Yes, the government is open to mixed rights solutions and will evaluate these solutions for suitability for transition. The goal of DARPAVERSE is to deliver an architecture and solution that can be delivered to and used by the warfighter.

Q7: Are FFRDCs eligible to participate in this opportunity?

A7: There are no restrictions for FFRDC's submission to the ERIS market place. However, FFRDC eligibility will still need to adhere to DARPA Policies.

Q8: Could you please share some specific example use cases that you envision the DARPAVERSE ecosystem would address? Specifically, we are curious about end user application scenarios, including problems to be addressed; examples of choices a user might want to specify within their inputs and what kinds of information they might want in the system response; what inputs and outputs might be expected for the underlying physics-based model(s), for the purpose of interfacing with TA1 and TA2.

A8: DARPAVERSE is open to all government use cases related to the missions of all DARPA offices.

Q9: What are the anticipated human/machine interaction modalities – AR/VR, tablet or phone, text based vs. verbal, multimodal, or something else?

A9: Proposers may include any human/machine modalities they believe will achieve program goals. This includes those listed in Q9.

Q10: Are real-time model adjustments planned – e.g. if a current 3-day weather model is insufficient, would you envision the end user requesting model changes on the fly?

A10: Yes.

Q11: Which TA is responsible for generating (not specifying) the integrated/composed multi-domain model for the user? Is that a responsibility of TA1 (owners of the repository of reduced order models), TA2 (owners of the orchestration design), or TA3 (owners of the orchestrated workflow specification)?

A11: TA1

Q12: Can you clarify the role of the 3D immersive environment? Is the development of such an environment (e.g., using Omniverse, OpenUSD) in-scope for TA3?

A12: The goal of DARPAVERSE is not to develop another 3D Immersive environment but to solve the DARPAVERSE technical objectives, including the ability to visualize results on traditional monitors or immersive environments. TA3 seeks the ability to map outcomes to multiple visualization assumptions.

Q13: Is the focus of TA3 on specification/disambiguation of the modeling request and the analysis of the resultant composed model, or should TA3 interfaces also enable the *use* of the resultant multi-domain model during concept/capability development?

A13: TA3 focus is to enable the use of the resultant model and present model specification issues, incompatibilities, and ambiguities to the user if present.

Q14: Does the TA3 error localization focus only on model specification errors, or should it also consider errors in the execution of the model during use?

A14: Specification errors and execution errors are both relevant to TA3.

Q15: Is teaming allowed for DARPAVERSE? In other words, will DARPA accept / consider proposals that involve two performer organizations (a prime and a sub)?

A15: Yes

Q16: For performers who pursue a single TA, can you describe how you anticipate inter-TA coordination occurring? Will this be brokered by the government?

A16: Inter-TA coordination will be defined by the government developed API which will be released to selected performers at kickoff.

Q17: Will there be a test & evaluation team? Can you provide any details about how performers will be tested and evaluated?

A17: Yes. Performers will be evaluated to the program metrics provided in the ERIS announcement.

Q18: Will the government provide any shared compute infrastructure or should performers plan to provide their own?

A18: DARPA will provide shared compute infrastructure for evaluation and encourages performers to provide their program development efforts.

Q19: Can you clarify the type of visualization expected of TA3 performers? Is visualization intended to visually enable the overall design of a simulated scenario, be the user's experience of the simulation as it unfolds, or be a means of visualizing the outputs of simulations? Or should performers address all or multiple of these aspects?

A19: Proposers may propose visualization approaches to achieve DARPAVERSE program objectives and reasons for those choices.

Q20: Do you anticipate any follow-on phases/contracts/transition opportunities beyond the 8-month period of performance?

A20: The results of the DARPAVERSE program that meet or exceed program metrics are intended to transition after the end of the program.

Q21: Will the program specify which simulation environment will be used? NVIDIA Omniverse was mentioned as an exemplar in the video. Should performers be expected to integrate with Omniverse or something similar?

A21: Responsive TA1 submissions must be modeling and simulation environment agnostic. The government will provide multiple reference environments for testing purposes.